Civil Disturbance Tactical Plan

Prepared by:
Orange County Fire Chiefs' Association
Orange County Fire Services
Operational Plan

INTENT

The tactical alert procedures contained here are intended to provide a standard approach for the Orange County Fire Chiefs to deal with incidents involving civil disturbance. This procedure will also contain components for standardizing EMS responses into impact areas, communications issues and coordination with law enforcement agencies.

These procedures are designed to be consistent with standardized ICS functional responsibilities and with the general procedures utilized by all Orange County fire services agencies. These procedures will assist in providing organization and continuity to multi-agency operations.

PROCEDURE

Basic Considerations

The Orange County Fire Chiefs are prepared to respond to any situations involving civil disturbance, to support the law enforcement effort and to continue to provide for public safety. It is the individual company officers' primary responsibility to provide for the safety of the firefighters under their control while attempting to accomplish their assigned mission. During a civil disturbance situation, company officers are granted the flexibility of deviating from the operational guidelines established by local policy in those situations where it is deemed to be in the best interest of the individual company. It must be restated with emphasis that the Orange County Fire Chiefs oppose carrying weapons on fire units. *Fire Investigators may be permitted to carry firearms on-duty, only if approved by their respective Fire Chiefs.* The prohibition forbidding unauthorized employees from carrying firearms on-duty will be strictly enforced. In addition, due to the added risk associated with identification of criminals through pictures, the carrying or use of cameras or video equipment while in an impact area will not be permitted for the safety of all personnel.

There are three levels to the tactical alert plan.

- Phase One - A planning phase in anticipation of a civil disturbance based on information received from a recognized public safety agency. This will generally be done on a local and county-wide basis and involves coordination with involved law enforcement agencies. Phase One will be implemented based on information that a civil disturbance is possible in the reasonably foreseeable future.

- Phase Two - The initial implementation of the developed tactical plan. It may include such actions as apparatus redeployment or staging, increased staffing, identification of staging areas or a mobilization center. Phase Two may be implemented based on information that a civil disturbance is likely to occur within a 24 to 48 hour period, or is occurring in a neighboring jurisdiction.

- Phase Three - The actual deployment of units according to the plan. All normal operations should be suspended in the impact areas. In conjunction with the responsible law enforcement agencies, a unified command will take over impact area operations. Branches, divisions and groups should be formed as necessary and all fire department responses into affected areas will be controlled by the appropriate command. Phase Three will be implemented in the event of civil disturbance occurring within a local jurisdiction or involving the response of local fire units under a mutual aid request.

Phase One Tactical Alert

At the declaration of a Phase One Tactical Alert, the ranking chief officer of the involved jurisdiction will convene such staff as deemed necessary to evaluate the available intelligence reports and develop contingency plans for Phases Two and Three. In most cases, this will involve coordination with fire agencies county-wide. Close coordination during this phase is essential. In addition, all companies will do the following:

- Insure that each unit with assigned personal body armor has its full complement carried on the unit and in a readily accessible location.

- Prepare fire stations in a manner to be easily secured if the company is deployed.

- Company officers should conduct a tailboard safety session with all crew members to discuss their Standard Operating Procedure for Civil Disturbance, Body Armor, and general safety (See Attachment A—Tailboard Safety Information).

Phase Two Tactical Alert

When a Phase Two Alert is declared, in addition to the above items, the following should be done immediately:

- Ranking On-Duty Chief Officer

Upon notification, begin the implementation of the plan developed in Phase One. This may include but not be limited to:

- Increase staffing on selected units

- A call-back or hold over of personnel to meet desired staffing needs.

- Pre-identify or stage task forces. Make preparations for each task force to have a leader (battalion chief) and three closed cab engines. One engine should have remote controlled elevated stream capability if possible, and one engine should be a paramedic engine or PAU with advanced life support (ALS) capability (see EMS Component").

- Establish a strong line of communications with local law enforcement agencies and the adjacent fire departments.

• Field Battalion Chiefs

- Remain in close contact with the ranking on-duty chief officer and/or the communications center to obtain the most current intelligence reports. Specific direction from each department will be made available as the various portions of the Phase One plan are implemented.

- Initiate contact with <u>all</u> on duty company officers to insure that they are aware of the potential situation. Provide them with specific direction in order to implement the desired portions of the Phase One plan.

- At this point, the battalion chiefs should closely monitor all incidents within the outlined tactical area.

• Company Officers

- During a Tactical Alert, consideration should be given to having all personnel wear safety equipment, such as a helmet and a wildland Nomex jacket or turn out coat, <u>on all incidents</u>. This will visually identify the wearer as a firefighter.

- Whenever a unit is driving or operating in or near an impact area, a helmet and eye protection should be worn in addition to the appropriate safety gear.

- Review the alert information to determine if the station is in an impact area. If so, prepare for potential evacuation of the station. Consideration should be given to having off- duty personnel take their turn out gear home so if a recall is necessary, personnel will be able to go directly to an assigned location.

- It is advisable to remove any equipment mounted on the exterior of the unit that could be used as a weapon against firefighters. Those items that can be stored inside compartments should be, other items should be left at the station. Ladders, due to the difficulty of removing them should be left as they are. Hose and nozzles should be placed well into the beds so that they cannot be easily reached from the ground.

- If at the station, consider securing it by closing and locking all exterior doors and gates; all window coverings should be drawn and closed; perimeter lights should be left on; personnel should not be near windows or in areas exposed to potential gunfire.

• Communication Centers

- At the direction of the ranking chief officer, notify all of the senior chief officers for the jurisdictions involved and the communications center for the Orange County Operational Area Coordinator. A courtesy notification of the on-duty senior chief officers of adjacent jurisdictions should also be initiated.

- Consideration should be given to having all units in the field that are not on active incidents to return to quarters.

- To the greatest extent of the communications system, consideration should be given to assigning a separate dispatch console and dispatcher during the disturbance.

- A communications plan should be developed and the assignment of separate tactical frequencies to major areas of disturbance should be considered.

Phase Three Tactical Alert

When a Phase Three Tactical Alert is activated by the ranking chief officer, appropriate battalion chief or dispatch supervisor the following actions will be taken:

- Ranking Chief Officer

  - Confirm the declaration of a Phase Three Tactical Alert. Insure that the declaration is announced via simulcast over all active radio channels and sent as a priority message to all units with MDT's. The information should include a confirmation of the staging and incident base locations as established by a field battalion chief or police agency and the established boundaries of the impact area.

  - Identify the boundaries of the impact area and update as needed.

  - Consider ordering selected fire units, operating within the perimeter of the impact area, to move immediately to specified staging areas.

  - Confirm and disseminate the location of the mobilization center. As the Operational Area Coordinator, the Orange County Fire Authority will assume the responsibility of setting up the mobilization center if the disturbance crosses local boundaries or involves multiple jurisdictions. When the center is opened, it will be staffed with 2 to 3 task forces consisting of three engines and a task force leader. They shall be drawn from all fire agencies county-wide.

  - Provide a full briefing for the jurisdictional chief officers.

- Battalion Chiefs

  - The battalion chief in whose area the primary civil disturbance is occurring should respond to law enforcement command post. There, he should meet with representatives from the involved police agencies at the command post and participate in a unified command.

  - Advise the ranking jurisdictional officer of the location of staging areas, base location and communication links.

  - Once the ICP is set up, a roll call should be initiated for the units in the affected areas. Normal dispatching into the impact area may

be suspended based on the assessment of the situation and threat to human life.

- Based on the results of the roll call and any pertinent information from the communications center, a list of units and their locations requiring extraction from the area should be given to the law enforcement representative. In the event that a representative has not arrived at the command post, the request should be transmitted through the local communications center to the proper agency. (See "Law Enforcement Component")

- Begin to collect and prioritize incident data for response as police protection for fire department elements becomes available. (See Law Enforcement Component")

- Battalion chiefs in uninvolved areas shall confirm receipt of the Phase Three Tactical Alert, assess the current situation and monitor events by radio and the media. A captain can be directed to continue this process in the event that the battalion is uncovered.

- Based on the local situation, direction may be given authorizing company officers to modify standard fire fighting tactics and utilize a "hit and run" approach where appropriate.

• Company Officers

- Answer the roll call and be prepared to give an assessment of the conditions in the immediate area of the station or current location of the unit.

- If directed to relocate to a staging area or incident base, do so in the most expeditious manner possible. This includes securing the station and may include bringing along any unmanned relief apparatus stored at the station.

- Use discretion when operating Code 3 - only use it when the benefit of the lights and siren outweighs the attention caused.

Following initiation of a Phase Two or Three Tactical Alert, individual units may be assigned to staging areas or mobilization centers. Mobilization centers are regional resource pooling centers. Police and fire units will be teamed up at these locations. Units will not drive through affected areas unless directed by the fire communications

center or the ICP. Units will not be sent to staging areas or incidents without a police security/escort. Those units already within affected areas should request police escort prior to moving through the area unless immediate danger requires a rapid departure. Communications or the ICP should be contacted with a request for law enforcement assistance for an extraction mission. Units may be sent to a mobilization center.

Units responding as mutual aid to incident areas outside of Orange County will first be formed into groups at a designated location within the county. They may be provided with police escorts. Response will be by designated secure routes. All responses in or around the actual impact area should be Code 2 unless the immediate situation dictates otherwise.

Law Enforcement Component, (see Addendum A - Agreement for Firefighter Security/Escort Procedure)

Extraction Mission

During the early stages of a civil disturbance there is a significant chance that response elements of the fire department will be deployed in the area on missions that began prior to the onset of the disturbance, or they may be housed in a station that is in the affected area. Fire department units shall use the Confidential Request for Law Enforcement" protocol when requesting police assistance due to a potentially violent situation, or when there is an immediate threat or danger to fire units on scene. (see Annex —Confidential Request For Law Enforcement). The purpose of these missions is to provide those units with immediate security and an escort to a designated staging or safe area.

> Fire responsibility: The fire department will identify those units that are deployed, or housed in the affected area and provide the local police agency with the locations of those units and request that an extraction mission be assigned to field police units.
>
> Law enforcement responsibility: Upon the receipt of a request from the fire department for an extraction mission, the concerned law enforcement agency will immediately assign that mission as a high priority to field units to provide security for the fire department elements deployed or housed in the affected area, and escort them to their designated staging area. If the units are currently on a mission, the law enforcement elements will provide them security while on scene and then escort them to the designated staging area upon completion of their mission.

Security / Escort Missions

Generally, security/escort missions will be requested by the fire department when response into an area affected by civil disturbance is anticipated. Fire and EMS equipment will not attempt to enter areas designated by law enforcement as "hot" due to the level of violence within that area, until adequate security has been provided and the response has been approved by law enforcement. This does not prohibit fire and law enforcement from making a mutual decision to enter such an area in cases of high life loss potential or other high priority needs.

The level of protection for fire and EMS elements will be set by the law enforcement agency, with input from the fire agency. The decisions will be based, in part, by the size of the fire element, i.e. strike team versus a task force, the level of risk anticipated in the area of the assignment and the resources available. It is intended that during a security/escort assignment, the law enforcement units will remain with the fire units for the entire time that they are deployed in the impact area.

PROCEDURES FOR REQUESTING ESCORT:

- Fire command will contact the lead law enforcement agency and request units for security/escort duty.
- The law enforcement agency will then either provide the needed police elements for the missions or request mutual aid through their area mutual aid coordinator, identifying the mission as a "fire security/escort."

- Once the required law enforcement elements are present at the staging area, the secured fire elements will then proceed with their assignments.

<u>Area Coordination</u>

The Orange County Operational Area Mutual Aid Area Coordinator will maintain a list of sites (a minimum of 3) suitable for mobilization centers. These sites will serve as an assembly point for resources gathering in preparation for a response within or outside of Orange County. The purpose of the mobilization center is to support a number of incidents by collecting and preparing resources for a rapid and safe response.

- The Orange County Operational Area Coordinator, upon determination of a Phase Two Tactical Alert by any agency within the county, will select an appropriate mobilization center and may after consulting with all Nets, dispatch the following support resources:

- 1 Mobilization Center Manager
- 1 Base Camp Manager
- 2 Safety Officers
- 1 Rehab Unit
- 1 Communications Technician
- 1 Command Vehicle

The Mobilization Center Manager will be responsible for supervising all activities and staff at the mobilization center. The Mobilization Center Manager will report directly to the Operational Area Coordinator until advised otherwise.

Resources dispatched to the County mobilization center will complete a "check in" process, be briefed on the current situation, be provided a communications plan, and receive a safety message and a unit inspection. A police escort will be assigned, if necessary, to provide protection for the fire resources.

If the primary purpose of the mobilization center is to support activities within Orange County, then additional resources will be dispatched to provide food, fuel, sleeping accommodations, etc.

EMS Component

This policy shall guide the emergency medical operations during incidents involving civil disturbance. The very nature of operating in an area of civil disturbance requires a deviation from established Orange County Emergency Services protocols.

While operating under a Phase Three Tactical Alert, the jurisdictional fire department IC may request the responsible Communications Center to activate the Mass Casualty Incident Response Plan for a specific impact area. This is done per Orange County EMSA Policy/Procedure #900.00. This will produce the following results:

- The paramedics operating in the declared impact zone will be exempt from the radio contact portion of their normal protocol allowing them to operate on standing orders.

- The hospital "Reddi-Net" system will be activated through Control 1 and a coordinated approach can be used to assign patients to hospitals out of the area affected by the civil disturbance.

- All patients transported out of the impact area will be taken to a hospital assigned by the incident medical branch in coordination with the "Reddi-Net" system.

A medical branch should be established as soon as possible and staffed with a qualified branch director. Once established, the Branch Director will work with the Operations Section Chief to staff the branch to the level of incident need and coordinate medical operations. The responsibilities of the branch will include:

- Insure that adequate ground ambulances are available for the incident.

- Request an ambulance company representative at the command post if necessary.

- Identify an ambulance staging area and appoint a manager.

- Coordinate with the incident operations to form up appropriately configured EMS response group's i.e. a two engine task force; one medic engine with one or more ambulances and law enforcement escort.

- Staff a Medical Communications Coordinator (Med-Com) and locate at the Incident Communications Unit.

- Designate patient transportation routes.

- Coordinate with the Air Operations Branch Director if air ambulances are used.

- Provide a Communications Plan to Med-Com and the Incident Dispatch.

Medical assistance requests from within the impact area will be routed as follows:

- Requests from incident personnel or any communications center will be directed to the Incident Communications Unit.

- The Medical Branch Director or his designee will prioritize the request, assign the appropriate resource configuration (based on type and location of the request) and direct the Incident Communications Unit to dispatch

the units. The Branch Director or designee should remain at the Incident Communications Unit.

- Med-Com will coordinate, through Control 1, with the designated Reddi-Net Control Point Hospital to determine receiving center locations, and through the Branch Director to determine safe routes of travel.

- Responding units will communicate with the Med-Com on a predesignated channel for hospital and route information.

The anticipated flow for medical aid requests would be from either the incident or a communications center to the Incident Communications Unit. From there to the EMS Branch Director, who would prioritize the request based on direction from the Incident Commander or Operations, and give the assignment to the Medical Group Supervisor, who in turn, sends the appropriate medical task force(s) to accomplish the mission. The task force would communicate directly with Med-Com to determine the hospital location for their patient(s) and an approved safe route.

By agreement of the Orange County Fire Chief's, all task forces that are staged in a mobilization center or deployed in an impact area will have Advanced Life Support (ALS) capability. This criteria can be met with either a medic engine or a unit with paramedic assessment (PA) capability. To facilitate this, the paramedic assessment protocol will be automatically activated by the Operational Area Coordinator at the time that they are advised of a level two activation anywhere in the County. This will be done as a part of the opening of the mobilization center and is intended to provide at least one paramedic with ALS capability per strike team/task force for the protection of the fire and police personnel assigned to that increment. When this activation takes place, the following will occur:

- The PA paramedic shall obtain from his department a paramedic assessment kit as defined in OCEMSA policy # (TBA)

- The paramedic will review the treatment protocols as outlined in OC EMSA PP#330.05 ALS treatment in a Major Medical Disaster and the associated record keeping requirements.

- Resupply of expended materials from the PA kit will be through the receiving hospital the patient was taken to or by request through the Incident Medical Branch

- It will be the responsibility of the PA paramedic to maintain accountability of the medical supplies.